

Scenario-Based Postman & API Interview Questions & Answers

Q1. API returns 200 OK but functionality is not working. Is it a failure?

Answer: Yes, incorrect or missing data makes it a functional defect even if the status code is 200.

Q2. GET API changes data in the database. Is it correct behavior?

Answer: No, GET should only retrieve data and must not modify the database.

Q3. API returns 204 No Content. Is it a failure?

Answer: No, it indicates the request was successful but there is no response body.

Q4. API works without authentication. Is this acceptable?

Answer: It depends, but for secured APIs this is a serious security issue.

Q5. API accepts wrong data type and still stores data. What does this indicate?

Answer: It indicates a validation defect in the API.

Q6. DELETE API returns success, but data still exists. What is your conclusion?

Answer: The API response is misleading and it is a functional bug.

Q7. PUT and PATCH behave the same way. Is that acceptable?

Answer: Not always, as PUT replaces the full resource while PATCH updates partial data.

Q8. Same API behaves differently for two users with the same role. What will you check?

Answer: I will check authorization rules, user-specific data, and backend logic.

Q9. You sent an API request but did not receive any response. What will you do?

Answer: I will check the URL, HTTP method, internet connection, server status, and Postman console for errors.

Q10. API returns 404 Not Found error. What does it indicate?

Answer: It indicates the endpoint URL is incorrect or the resource does not exist.

Q11. You are getting a 401 Unauthorized error. What will you verify?

Answer: I will verify if the authorization token is added correctly and is valid.

Q12. GET request works but POST request fails. What could be the reason?

Answer: POST requires a body, so I will check JSON format, mandatory fields, and Content-Type header.

Q13. API accepts only JSON input. What configuration will you use in Postman?

Answer: I will select Body → raw → JSON and add Content-Type as application/json.

Q14. A mandatory field is missing in the request. What response do you expect?

Answer: I expect a 400 Bad Request response.

Q15. How do you test an invalid login scenario using Postman?

Answer: I will send incorrect credentials and validate the error code and message.

Q16. Login API returns a token. How will you use it in subsequent APIs?

Answer: I will extract the token, store it in an environment variable, and use it as a Bearer token.

Q17. How do you pass dynamic data from one API to another?

Answer: I will extract the required value from the response and store it in an environment variable.

Q18. How do you test the same API in Dev and QA environments?

Answer: I will use environment variables for the base URL and switch environments.

Q19. You need to test the same API in Dev, QA, and Prod. How will you manage this?

Answer: I will configure environment variables so the base URL changes without modifying requests.

Q20. API response contains multiple records. How will you validate the response?

Answer: I will ensure the response array is not empty and validate key fields like id and name.

Q21. How do you validate response headers in Postman?

Answer: I will check important response headers such as Content-Type.

Q22. API response time is higher than expected. What will you do?

Answer: I will check response time and report if it exceeds the acceptable limit.

Q23. API returns 500 Internal Server Error. What is your approach?

Answer: I will verify payload and headers, and report it as a backend issue if correct.

Q24. How do you validate a DELETE API?

Answer: I will check the status code and confirm deletion with a GET request.

Q25. What is negative testing in Postman?

Answer: Negative testing checks API behavior with invalid, missing, or incorrect data.

Q26. How do you execute multiple APIs together in Postman?

Answer: I will add APIs to a collection and run them using Collection Runner.

Q27. How do you troubleshoot API failures in Postman?

Answer: I will review URL, headers, body, status code, response, and Postman console logs.

Q28. What details should be included while reporting an API defect?

Answer: I will include endpoint URL, HTTP method, request body, headers, response, and status code.

Q29. API works in Postman but fails when called from the application. Why?

Answer: The application may be missing headers, tokens, or sending incorrect data.

Q30. Same API gives different responses for the same request. What could be the reason?

Answer: It could be due to caching issues, server instability, or backend data changes.